

THE HOPECORE PROJECT

Lesser-Known Internet Hacks & Hidden Features. Here are some genuinely obscure tricks most people don't know about.

Browser & Video Tricks

- **YouTube keyboard shortcuts** — Press **J** to rewind 10 seconds, **L** to forward 10 seconds, **;** for frame-by-frame on paused video.
- Brave Browser - Use to watch youtube ad free.
- **YouTube's free tier loopholes** — Use `youtube.com/tv` on desktop for a cleaner interface; YouTube Music free tier includes background play in some regions
- **Invidious instances** — Privacy-focused YouTube frontends (invidious.io alternatives) with no ads, no tracking, downloadable videos
- **Piped.kavin.rocks** — Another YouTube proxy; lightweight, ad-free, works when YouTube blocks VPNs
- **Freetube** — Desktop app that lets you watch YouTube without the algorithm or ads
- **NewPipe** — Android app for YouTube without Google Play Services; background play, downloads built-in

Streaming & Media

- **Tubi, Pluto TV, Freevee** — Completely free streaming with minimal ads (legal, ad-supported)
- **Internet Archive's Wayback Machine** — Access deleted web pages, old versions of sites
- **Sci-Hub** — Free academic papers (legal gray area, but widely used)
- **Library Genesis** — Free ebooks and textbooks (similar legal status)
- **Zotero** — Free research paper manager with built-in PDF tools

Productivity Secrets

- **Notion database formulas** — Create complex workflows without paying for Zapier
- **Google Sheets IMPORTHTML** — Scrape data from websites directly into sheets
- **Overleaf free tier** — Unlimited private LaTeX documents (academics' secret weapon)
- **Excalidraw** — Free, open-source diagramming tool (rivals Lucidchart)

Development & Hosting

- **Vercel, Netlify free tier** — Deploy websites and apps for free with generous limits
- **Railway, Render** — Free tier for backend hosting (better than Heroku now)
- **Supabase** — Free PostgreSQL database with real-time features
- **Cloudflare Workers** — Free serverless functions with global CDN
- **GitHub Copilot free trial** — 60 days free AI code completion (then paid, but free for students)

Security & Privacy

- **Mullvad VPN** — Free VPN with no account required, no logs
- **ProtonMail** — Free encrypted email (limited but functional)
- **Signal** — Free encrypted messaging (no ads, no data collection)
- **Tor Browser** — Free anonymity tool; built on Firefox
- **Have I Been Pwned** — Check if your email is in data breaches

AI & Automation

- **Hugging Face** — Free AI models, datasets, and inference
- **Replicate** — Free tier for running AI models (image generation, etc.)
- **OpenRouter** — Access multiple AI models including Claude with free credits
- **Perplexity AI** — Free AI search engine (better than ChatGPT for research)

Niche Gems

- **Syncthing** — Free, decentralized file sync (no cloud needed, no limits)
- **Jellyfin** — Self-hosted media server (better than Plex for privacy)
- **Immich** — Self-hosted Google Photos alternative
- **Vaultwarden** — Self-hosted Bitwarden server (unlimited passwords)
- **Lemmy/Mastodon** — Free, decentralized social media alternatives

Money-Saving Hacks

- **Honey, Rakuten browser extensions** — Automatic cashback and coupon codes
- **Library apps** — Free ebooks, audiobooks, movies through your local library (Libby, Hoopla)
- **Student discounts** — GitHub Student Pack gives \$200+ in free credits
- **Refund apps** — Fetch Rewards, Ibotta scan receipts for cashback